Jack Le

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Education

University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, TX, United States — August 2022–Present
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science with Honors — Graduation: December 2026
Minors: Mathematics and Political Science · GPA: overall 3.97/4.0; CS-only 3.96/4.0
Honors: The Honor Society of Phi Kappa Phi, Collegium V Honors, Dean's List (x3)

Refereed Abstracts

Jack Le. *Do Machines Struggle Where Humans Do? Obfuscation as a Probe of Human and Machine Code Comprehension.* In *Companion Proceedings of SPLASH '26*, ACM Student Research Competition, pp. 45–46, 2026. DOI: 10.1145/3837729.3839573. Featured in the ACM Showcase on Kudos.

Workshop Papers

Jack Le and Tien Nguyen. *Attributing Gains in Paired Training: Objective or Data Direction?* [Non-archival]. Third NeurIPS Workshop on Attributing Model Behavior at Scale: Data Attribution and Provenance (ATTRIB 2026). 43 of 83 submissions accepted (51.8%).

Preprints

Jack Le and Tien Nguyen. *Directional Collapse in Fine-Tuning: Preserving the Way Back.* Submitted to ACL Rolling Review (ARR), October 2026.

Jack Le and Tien Nguyen. *Correct Values Can Be Recovered Before Wrong Reasoning Steps.* Submitted to ACL Rolling Review (ARR), October 2026.

Jack Le and Tien Nguyen. *Composing Obfuscation Specialists by Merging.* Submitted to ICSE.

Vincent Hanke, **Jack Le**, Adam Dziedzic, and Franziska Boenisch. *Router-Free Modular Storage for Knowledge Unlearning in Large Language Models.* Submitted to ICLR.

Jack Le, Ilse Lahnstein, Anh Nguyen, and Tien Nguyen. *Fast Errors or Slow Effort? Divergent Dual-Process Signatures of Code Obfuscation in Humans and Language Models.* Submitted to ICSE.

Jack Le, Rebecca Gelles, Catherine Aiken, and Katherine Quinn. *Extreme Summarization of Worldwide Scientific and Patent Document Clusters for Landscape Analysis.* Submitted to Scientometrics.

Jack Le, Anh Nguyen, and Tien Nguyen. *Do Machines Struggle Where Humans Do? LLM and Human Comprehension of Obfuscated Code.* Submitted to ICSE.

Jack Le, Anh Nguyen, Ilse Lahnstein, and Tien Nguyen. *The Effect of Code Obfuscation on Human Program Comprehension.* Submitted for review.

Philosophical Preprints

Jack Le. *What Does an Embedding Mean? A Semiotic Account of Learned Representation.* Preprint.

Kumiko Tanaka-Ishii and **Jack Le**. *Code as Embedding as AI.* Submitted to Minds and Machines.

Presentations

Do Machines Struggle Where Humans Do? LLM and Human Comprehension of Obfuscated Code. Gulf Coast Undergraduate Research Symposium (GCURS), Rice University, October 2026.

Exact Unlearning for Large Language Models. DAAD RISE Research Symposium, 2026.

Head Shape Analysis Using Custom Feature Extraction. UT Dallas Undergraduate Research Scholars Awards Symposium, 2025.

Evaluating Large Language Models in Scientific Research: Practical Applications and Challenges. UT Dallas Summer Platform for Undergraduate Students, 2024.

Coding Semantics: Sentiment Analysis for Movie Reviews. [Co-presented]. ACM UTD Research Conference, 2023.

Research Experience

Undergraduate Researcher with Dr. Tien Nguyen — Fall 2025–Present
Worked on the *Attention Reallocation for LLMs in Software Engineering* project.

Research Intern at SprintML, CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security — Summer 2026
Worked on the *Efficient Exact Unlearning for LLMs* project.

Research Assistant with Dr. Kumiko Tanaka-Ishii — Fall 2024–Summer 2025
Worked on the *Recurrence Quantification Analysis of Frontier AI Models* project.

Undergraduate Researcher with Dr. Ovidiu Daescu — Spring 2024–Fall 2026
Worked on the *Computer Vision and Feature Selection* project.

Research Intern with Dr. Julia Hsu — Summer 2024
Worked on the *Machine Learning Applications in Materials Science* project.

Student Researcher with Dr. Doug DeGroot — Fall 2023
Worked on the *Coding Semantics: Sentiment Analysis in Movie Reviews* project.

Industry Experience

Center for Security and Emerging Technology, Georgetown University — Spring 2026
Intern

Onplanetz — Fall 2024–Spring 2025
AI Engineer Intern

Relativity — Fall 2024
AI Studio Fellow

Teaching Experience

UTD ECS 1192/2192 RIDE Research Projects, *Research Mentor* — Fall 2025, Fall 2026
10 undergraduates (Fall 2026); 4 undergraduates and 1 master's student (Fall 2025)

UTD CS 2340 Computer Architecture, *Grader* — Fall 2026
UTD CS 1337 Computer Science I, *Grader* — Fall 2025
UTD CS 2336 Computer Science II, *Grader* — Spring 2024
UTD CS 1337 Computer Science I, *Teaching Assistant* — Spring 2024
UTD CS 1334 Programming Fundamentals for Non-Majors, *Teaching Assistant* — Fall 2023
Garland ISD, Various Math Courses, *Substitute Teacher* — Spring 2023–Present
Jeremy E. Watson Educational Center Inc., *Japanese Instructor* — Fall 2023–Spring 2024
iCode School, Introduction to Web Development, *Technical Lead* — Fall 2023–Spring 2024

Other Experience

UT Dallas Office of Research, *Research Information Systems Worker* — Summer 2024
Break Through Tech AI, *AI/ML Fellow* — May 2024–May 2025
ACM UTD, *Back-end Developer* — February 2024–April 2024
UTDesign, *Frontend Software Developer* — January 2024–May 2024
Wolters Kluwer Tax and Accounting, *Extern* — March 2023

Awards

2026 DAAD RISE Scholarship – $5,000
2026 Undergraduate Research Scholarship Award (URSA), 2x – $500 each
2026 Spring Archer Fellow – $10,000
2025 Barry Goldwater Scholarship – $7,500
2025 Undergraduate Research Scholarship Award (URSA) – $500
2024 Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Fellowship Award (URAP) – $4,500
2024 People's Choice Award, Association for Computing Machinery Projects
2024 Leland Dillaha MSEE '97 Undergraduate Scholarship – $1,000
2022 National Merit Scholarship, UT Dallas – $3,000

Languages

Japanese: JLPT N1, 150/180 (CEFR C1); self-taught

Service

ATTRIB 2026, NeurIPS Workshop on Attributing Model Behavior at Scale, *Reviewer* — 2026

Community Involvement

UTDesign, *Code Review Volunteer* — Summer 2024
UTD Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers, *Secretary and Chair* — January 2023–August 2024
UTD Artificial Intelligence Society, *Officer* — October 2022–May 2023